STUDENT LESSON OUTLINE

SWIM & WATER SAFETY

Health & Physical Education · Year 7 · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

📅 5 Lessons × 50 min | 🏫 Classroom-based | 📋 Victorian Curriculum 2.0 | 🌊 Safety Focus Area | 💧 Dry-land unit

STUDENT NAME _____ CLASS _____ TEACHER _____

> **How to use this document:** This outline shows you what you will be learning, doing, and achieving across the five lessons of our Water Safety unit. At the start of each lesson, read the *Learning Intention* (what we're aiming for) and the *Success Criteria* (what you can do to show you've got it). At the end of each lesson, check the criteria — can you tick them? If not, that's what to focus on before the next lesson.

📋 Unit Overview — What this unit is about

Unit Title	Swim & Water Safety: Making Smart Choices in Victorian Waters
Year Level	Year 7 (Ages 12–13)
Duration	5 × 50-minute lessons
Big Question	*"What knowledge, skills and decisions could prevent most Victorian drowning deaths — including among people our age?"*
Why it matters	In 2024–25, 52 people drowned in Victoria. Seven were aged 15–24 — about 1 in 8, at a rate 21% above the ten-year average. There were no deaths in public swimming pools, but a quarter happened in home environments. This unit gives you the knowledge and skills to protect yourself and help others.

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Resources you'll use	Student Workbook · Poster Pack (4 posters) · Scenario Activity Cards · BeachSafe app (beachsafe.org.au) · Life Saving Victoria data (lsv.com.au)
Assessment	**Workbook** (Sections 1–6, collected end of unit) and **Communication Campaign** task (Lesson 5) — design a water safety product for a real audience of your choice

📌 VICTORIAN CURRICULUM 2.0 — CONTENT DESCRIPTIONS IN THIS UNIT

Code	What it means in plain language	Lessons
VC2HP8P10	Plan and implement strategies, using health resources, to enhance their own and others' health, safety, relationships and wellbeing — you will research and choose water safety strategies that work in Victorian environments	1, 2, 3, 4
VC2HP8P10	Plan and use strategies and resources to enhance the health, safety and wellbeing of your community — you will make a real action plan and create a water safety communication product	3, 5
VC2HP8P09	Evaluate health information and express health concerns — you will analyse Victorian drowning data and use evidence to back up your safety arguments	1, 5
VC2HP8P08	Refine protective behaviours and evaluate community resources to seek help for themselves and others (including basic first aid and CPR) — you will explore how peer pressure works near water and develop strategies to resist unsafe decisions	4
VC2HP8M01	Refine and perform specialised movement skills in aquatic environments — you will learn survival swimming theory, throw rescue techniques, and aquatic safety skills	3

LESSON 1

Victoria's Drowning Crisis — Why It Matters to You

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 1 | 🏫 Classroom | VC2HP8P10 | VC2HP8P09

🎯 LEARNING INTENTION

We are learning to understand why water safety matters in Victoria by investigating current drowning data and explaining the key risk factors that affect young people.

✅ SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN SHOW I'VE ACHIEVED THIS WHEN I CAN:

- [ ] **Identify and interpret** at least four key facts from the LSV 2024–25 Victorian drowning report (e.g. total deaths, age groups, locations, gender) and explain what each fact tells us about risk — VC2HP8P09
- [ ] **Explain at least two reasons** why teenagers and young people in Victoria face a higher drowning risk, drawing on the data and connecting it to real-life behaviours such as peer pressure and overconfidence — VC2HP8P10
- [ ] **Describe why swimming at patrolled locations** is the single most important action to reduce drowning risk, using evidence from the Victorian data to support the statement (e.g. zero deaths at patrolled locations in 2024–25) — VC2HP8P10

📋 WHAT WE'LL DO THIS LESSON

🔥 **Engage**
10 min
"Name the 3 closest bodies of water to where you live" — think-pair-share, then class discussion of drowning statistics

🔍 **Explore**
15 min
Personal connection survey (Activity 1.1) and data table analysis (Activity 1.2) — what does each statistic mean?

📣 **Explain**
15 min
Class discussion: why are teenagers at higher risk? Peer pressure, overconfidence, gender, cultural background

✏️ **Elaborate**
8 min

📝 **Exit Ticket**
5 min

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Written responses to Questions 1.2a and 1.2b in workbook — use the data to explain your answer

Write: ONE fact that surprised you + ONE question you still have

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📚 KEY VOCABULARY

patrolled beach | **unpatrolled** | **drowning statistics** | **risk factors** | **peer pressure** | **overconfidence** | **LSV**

📖 **Resources:** Workbook Section 1 · Poster 3 (Victorian Drowning Statistics) · LSV Drowning Report — https://lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

END OF LESSON

Look back at the success criteria above. Which can you already tick? Which do you need to revisit? Note your answer here:

_____

LESSON 2

Beach Flags, Signals & Rip Current Survival

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 2 | 🏫 Classroom | VC2HP8P10

🎯 LEARNING INTENTION

We are learning to identify Australian beach flag signals and apply the correct survival response to a rip current situation.

✅ SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN SHOW I'VE ACHIEVED THIS WHEN I CAN:

- [ ] **Correctly name and describe the purpose** of all six beach flags used in Australia (red & yellow, red, black & white quartered, yellow + black ball, orange windsock, purple), including where swimmers should and should not go — VC2HP8P10
- [ ] **Describe in sequence the five survival steps** to take if caught in a rip current — Stay calm → Float → Swim parallel → Angle back to shore → Signal for help — and **explain why** swimming directly against the current is dangerous — VC2HP8P10
- [ ] **Analyse a scenario** (Liam's story) and identify at least two mistakes made, explaining what the safer course of action would have been using correct water safety vocabulary — VC2HP8P10

📋 WHAT WE'LL DO THIS LESSON

🔥
Engage
8 min
Flag quiz — 6 flags on screen, no labels. Write what each means on mini-whiteboard or paper

🔍
Explore
12 min
Activity 2.1: Flag identification in workbook, then peer-check using Poster 2

📣
Explain
12 min
Teacher explanation of rip currents using the workbook diagram + short SLSA video on rip current escape

✏️
Elaborate
12 min
Activity 2.2: Liam's scenario + Questions 2.2a–c. Optional: Scenario Cards B1, B2, B3 as station activities

📱
Evaluate
6 min
BeachSafe app demo — find your 3 nearest patrolled beaches. Preview SwimSafe Rules (Poster 4)

📚 KEY VOCABULARY

rip current | **feeder current** | **swim parallel** | **lifeguard** | **red and yellow flags** | **offshore wind** | **BeachSafe**

📖 **Resources:** Workbook Section 2 · Poster 2 (Beach Flags) · Poster 4 (SwimSafe Rules) · SLSA Rip Current Video — https://sls.com.au/surf-safety/rip-currents/ · BeachSafe — https://beachsafe.org.au

END OF LESSON

Can you recite the 5 rip current survival steps without looking at your workbook now:

LESSON

3

Emergency Response — DRS ABCD & Rescue Skills

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 3 | 🏫 Classroom + Practical

VC2HP8P10 VC2HP8P10 VC2HP8M01

🎯 LEARNING INTENTION

We are learning to apply the DRS ABCD emergency action plan in a water-related scenario and demonstrate safe rescue principles without entering the water.

✅ SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN SHOW I'VE ACHIEVED THIS WHEN I CAN:

- [ ] **Recall and correctly sequence all seven DRS ABCD steps** from memory — Danger, Response, Send (call 000), Airway, Breathing, CPR, Defibrillation — and describe the specific action required at each step — VC2HP8P10

- [ ] **Explain and apply the 'Throw, Don't Go' principle**, including why untrained bystanders who enter the water to help often drown themselves, and identify at least three objects that can be used as throw rescue aids — VC2HP8P10

- [ ] **Demonstrate the correct body position and rhythm** for chest compressions during CPR practice (30 compressions: 2 breaths cycle, approximately 100–120 bpm), and **describe what information to give** when calling 000 in a water emergency — VC2HP8M01

📋 WHAT WE'LL DO THIS LESSON

🔥
Engage
5 min
DRS ABCD Reveal Game — 7 letter cards, volunteers flip, class guesses the word

🔍
Explore
15 min
CPR demonstration by teacher, then student practice in pairs on cushions/mats. 30 compressions + 2 breaths

📣
Explain
8 min
Throw rescue technique — demonstrated with rope/towel. RLSSA hierarchy: Talk → Reach → Throw → Row → Go

✏️
Elaborate

📝
Evaluate

15 min

Workbook Activities 3.1 (DRS ABCD table) and 3.2 (River Rope Swing scenario) in pairs. Optional: Scenario Cards E1 and E2

7 min

Role-play calling 000: one student calls, teacher plays dispatcher. Class gives feedback

📚 KEY VOCABULARY

DRS ABCD | **CPR** | **AED / defibrillator** | **airway** | **throw rescue** | **000** | **cardiac arrest** | **bystander**

📖 **Resources:** Workbook Section 3 · Poster 1 (DRS ABCD) · Scenario Cards E1, E2 · CPR manikin or cushions · St John Ambulance — https://www.stjohnvic.com.au/first-aid-resources/

END OF LESSON

Without looking at your notes, write the DRS ABCD letters and one action for e

LESSON

4

Hazard Mapping, Safe Decisions, Inland Waterways & Alcohol

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Sections 4–5 | 🏫 Classroom

VC2HP8P08 | VC2HP8P10

🎯 LEARNING INTENTION

We are learning to identify and rank hazards across different Victorian water environments, evaluate the impact of peer pressure and alcohol on water safety decisions, and apply the LSV SwimSafe rules to plan for a safe water experience.

✅ SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN SHOW I'VE ACHIEVED THIS WHEN I CAN:

- ☐ **Identify and rank specific hazards** in at least three Victorian water environments (beach, river/dam, pool), explain why rivers and dams cause the most Victorian drowning deaths, and link this to evidence from LSV data — VC2HP8P10
- ☐ **Recall all five LSV SwimSafe rules** from memory and **apply them** to a realistic personal water safety scenario — demonstrating that the rules can be used to make safer choices in real Victorian settings — VC2HP8P10
- ☐ **Describe at least two specific strategies** to resist peer pressure to swim somewhere unsafe, and **explain at least three ways** alcohol increases the risk of drowning — connecting both to the patterns seen in Victorian drowning data — VC2HP8P08

📋 WHAT WE'LL DO THIS LESSON

🔥
Engage
8 min
"Would You?" — values clarification. Stand left (would) or right (wouldn't) for three water risk scenarios. Discuss why

🔍
Explore
15 min
Activity 4.0: Hazard Mapping in pairs — list and rank hazards at beach, river/dam, and pool. Apply SwimSafe rules using Poster 4

📣
Explain
10 min
Cold water shock in Victorian inland waterways — the 1-10-1 rule, Alpine lake temperatures, Paddle Australia safety resources

✏️

📝

Elaborate

12 min

Activities 4.1 (Risk vs. Benefit), 5.2 (Throw Rescue ranking), 5.3 (Alcohol & Water). Scenario Cards D1 and D2 as extensions

Evaluate

5 min

Share with a partner: which SwimSafe rule is most important for you personally and why?

📚 KEY VOCABULARY

cold water shock · **gasp reflex** · **inland waterway** · **SwimSafe rules** · **hazard ranking** · **peer pressure** · **risk vs. benefit** · **1-10-1 rule**

📖 **Resources:** Workbook Sections 4–5 · Poster 4 (SwimSafe Rules) · Scenario Cards D1, D2, R2, R3 · Paddle Australia — https://paddle.org.au · Parks Victoria — https://www.parks.vic.gov.au

END OF LESSON

Write the 5 SwimSafe rules from memory: 1._____ 2._____ 3._____ 4._____ 5._____

LESSON

5

Personal Action Plan & Communication Campaign

⏱ 50 min | 📖 Workbook Section 6 | 🏫 Classroom | 📝 Assessment | VC2HP8P09 | VC2HP8P10

🎯 LEARNING INTENTION

We are learning to apply our water safety knowledge by creating a personal action plan for a real Victorian setting and producing a communication product that promotes water safety for a specific audience.

✅ SUCCESS CRITERIA — I CAN SHOW I'VE ACHIEVED THIS WHEN I CAN:

- ☐ **Produce a personalised water safety action plan** for a chosen Victorian water activity (beach, river, pool, or paddling), identifying specific hazards, safety strategies, emergency plan, and equipment — going beyond generic answers to show real personal thinking — VC2HP8P10
- ☐ **Create a water safety communication product** (social media post, letter, or community fact sheet) that clearly targets a specific audience, includes at least one accurate statistic with its source URL, and includes a clear call to action — VC2HP8P10
- ☐ **Select and use credible health information sources** — such as Life Saving Victoria, Paddle Australia, Parks Victoria, or Royal Life Saving Society Australia — to support the claims made in the communication campaign, correctly citing the source URL — VC2HP8P09

📋 WHAT WE'LL DO THIS LESSON

🔥 **Engage**

8 min

Revision quiz (Kahoot/Quizlet) covering all 4 previous lessons. Optional: Scenario Card rapid-fire showdown as a class

✏️ **Elaborate**

30 min

Activity 6.1: Personal Action Plan (Workbook). Activity 6.2: Communication Campaign — choose Option A (social media), B (letter), or C (fact sheet for new Australians)

📝 **Evaluate**

12 min

Peer share of campaign (2 min each, one piece of feedback). Complete self-assessment checklist. Submit workbook

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📋 ASSESSMENT TASK — COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN OPTIONS

Option A

Social media post (Instagram/TikTok style) for teenagers. 1–2 slides. Must include a statistic + source + call to action.

Option B

Letter (~200 words) to a Year 5 student explaining three things they must know about Victorian water safety before summer.

Option C ★

Multilingual community fact sheet about beach flags and Victorian waterway dangers for someone new to Australia. 5 key points + 2 statistics.

📚 KEY VOCABULARY

action plan · **call to action** · **target audience** · **source URL** · **evidence-based** · **community wellbeing** · **health promotion**

📖 **Resources:** Workbook Section 6 · All 4 Posters · LSV — lsv.com.au · LSV Drowning Reports — lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy · Paddle Australia — paddle.org.au · Victorian Curriculum — victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au

UNIT COMPLETE

Go back to page 1. Which of the unit's five big Success Criteria are you most proud of achieving? Write it here:

_____

Swim & Water Safety — Student Lesson Outline
Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · HPE · Year 7 · Safety Focus Area
VC2HP8P08 · VC2HP8P09 · VC2HP8P10 · VC2HP8M01

Life Saving Victoria: lsv.com.au
Victorian Curriculum: victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au
BeachSafe: beachsafe.org.au · RLSSA: royallifesaving.com.au

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